

Restarting a **Git Project** After a Break



Before you start coding again, make sure your local repository is clean and properly synced with GitHub.



Correct branch



Clean repository



Same latest commit



```
PS C:\Users\Student\Desktop\my-project> git status  
On branch main  
Your branch is up to date with 'origin/main'.  
  
nothing to commit, working tree clean
```

1. Start in the Right Folder

Before running Git commands, make sure the terminal is open in the project folder.



PowerShell opened in the project folder



The path should match your repo



Otherwise, the checks are not meaningful



```
PS C:\Users\Student\Desktop\my-project> git status
On branch main
Your branch is up to date with 'origin/main'.

nothing to commit, working tree clean
```



2. Check the Branch and Repository State

Start by checking that you are on the right branch and that your local repository is clean.



Current branch: main



No files to commit



Working tree clean

```
PS C:\Users\Student\Desktop\my-project> git branch --show-current  
main
```

```
PS C:\Users\Student\Desktop\my-project> git status  
On branch main  
Your branch is up to date with 'origin/main'.  
  
nothing to commit, working tree clean
```

3

Refresh the remote information

We fetch the latest updates from GitHub without modifying our local files.



```
PS C:\Users\Student\Desktop\my-project> git fetch origin

From https://github.com/example/my-project
* [new branch]    feature/dashboard -> origin/feature/dashboard
* [new branch]    fix/typo          -> origin/fix/typo

PS C:\Users\Student\Desktop\my-project> █
```



Good to know

`git fetch` only retrieves information.
It does not modify your files, your branches, or your current work.
It is safe to run, even if you have local changes.

1

Fetch the latest updates

```
git fetch origin
```

This downloads the latest information from the remote repository (new commits, branches, etc.) without changing your local code.

2

Read the output

The command shows you what has changed on GitHub since your last fetch (new branches, new commits, updates, etc.).



What you should see

- ✓ A list of new commits (if any)
- ✓ New branches from the remote (if any)
- ✓ No changes to your local files

4. Compare the Latest Commit



Check that your local latest commit is exactly the same as the one on the remote branch.



Same hash



Same commit message



Local and remote match



```
PS C:\Users\Student\Desktop\my-project> git log -1 --oneline  
6e7a056 feat: add synthetic data viewer
```

```
PS C:\Users\Student\Desktop\my-project> git log origin/main -1 --oneline  
6e7a056 feat: add synthetic data viewer
```



Check the local commit

```
git log -1 --oneline
```



Check the remote commit

```
git log origin/main -1 --oneline
```



Why?

If both lines are identical, your local branch and GitHub point to the same latest commit, so you can resume work confidently.